

PayForMe — SMS Integration (Arkesel)

Version: 1.0

Provider: [Arkesel](#) (recommended for Ghana)

Prerequisite: Complete [Company onboarding requirements](#) and obtain an approved Sender ID

1. Overview

PayForMe uses SMS for:

- Phone verification (OTP)
- Withdrawal OTP
- Login / security alerts
- Notification delivery (when email + in-app are insufficient)

The default production provider is **Arkesel**. Development uses `SMS_PROVIDER=log` (console only).

2. Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Arkesel account	Register at https://sms.arkesel.com
API key	Dashboard → API
Sender ID	Approved alphanumeric ID (max 11 characters), e.g. PayForMe
Company KYB	Certificate of incorporation, TIN, business registration — see company onboarding
Ghana phone format	Numbers normalized to +233XXXXXXXX

3. Environment variables

```
SMS_PROVIDER=arkesel

# Arkesel credentials
SMS_API_KEY=your_arkesel_api_key
ARKESEL_SMS_SENDER_ID=PayForMe
ARKESEL_SMS_API_VERSION=legacy
SMS_API_URL=https://sms.arkesel.com/sms/api
```

Variable	Required	Description
SMS_PROVIDER	Yes	arkesel, hubtel, twilio, or log
SMS_API_KEY	Yes (Arkesel)	API key from dashboard
ARKESEL_SMS_SENDER_ID	Yes	Approved sender name (≤ 11 chars)

ARKESEL_SMS_API_VERSION	No	legacy (default) or v2
SMS_API_URL	No	Default https://sms.arkesel.com/sms/api

Ready-to-copy block: [docs/arkesel-copy-to-env.txt](https://docs.arkesel.com/docs/arkesel-copy-to-env.txt)

Windows helper: `powershell -File scripts/apply-arkesel-env.ps1`

4. How it works in the app

```
User action (verify phone, withdrawal, etc.)
→ notification.service / auth.service
→ sms.service.sendSms()
→ lib/integrations/sms/arkesel.ts
→ Arkesel HTTP API
```

Legacy API (default): GET request with query params `action=send-sms` , `api_key` , `to` , `from` , `sms` .

V2 API: Set `ARKESEL_SMS_API_VERSION=v2` → POST to `https://sms.arkesel.com/api/v2/sms/send` .

5. Phone number format

- Input: `0241234567` , `241234567` , `+233241234567`
- Normalized to Ghana international format before sending
- Arkesel receives digits without `+` prefix

6. SMS use cases in PayForMe

Flow	Trigger	Channel
Phone verification	Register / resend OTP	SMS + email
Withdrawal OTP	Wallet withdrawal request	SMS + email
Security notifications	Optional per notification	SMS

7. Testing

Development (`SMS_PROVIDER=log`)

Messages are logged to the server console — no real SMS sent.

Staging / production

1. Set `SMS_PROVIDER=arkesel` and valid API key
2. Use a real Ghana mobile number you control
3. Trigger phone verification from `/verify-phone`
4. Confirm delivery and Sender ID display on handset

8. Troubleshooting

Issue	Fix
SMS not sent	Check SMS_API_KEY and ARKESEL_SMS_SENDER_ID
Sender ID rejected	Ensure ID is approved in Arkesel dashboard
Invalid number	Use +233 format; verify normalizeGhanaPhone
401 / auth error	Regenerate API key; no extra spaces in .env
Works locally, not prod	Confirm env vars on hosting platform (Vercel, etc.)

9. Security

- Never commit SMS_API_KEY to git
- Rotate keys if exposed
- Rate-limit OTP endpoints (built into app)
- Log provider responses server-side only

10. Alternative providers

Provider	Env	Notes
Hubtel	SMS_PROVIDER=hubtel	HUBTEL_SMS_CLIENT_ID, HUBTEL_SMS_CLIENT_SECRET, HUBTEL_SMS_SENDER_ID
Twilio	SMS_PROVIDER=twilio	International; TWILIO_ACCOUNT_SID, TWILIO_AUTH_TOKEN, TWILIO_PHONE_NUMBER
Log (dev)	SMS_PROVIDER=log	No external calls

11. Related files

Path	Purpose
lib/integrations/sms/arkesel.ts	Arkesel HTTP client
lib/services/sms.service.ts	Provider routing
scripts/apply-arkesel-env.ps1	Windows env helper
__tests__/arkesel-sms.test.ts	Configuration tests

12. Related documentation

- [Company onboarding](#)
- [Platform integrations guide](#) (combined PDF)